Lab 56: Delegate the noisy search, keep a scratchpad

Topic 5: Context Management & Reliability · Task 5.4: Manage context effectively in large codebase exploration

Runs on Simulator 4: Developer Productivity with Claude · Run in class

Source: Built from exam guide task statement 5.4 (no practice question covers this angle)

Commit to an answer first

You need every caller of a function, but a wide search would flood your main session. How do you find them and keep your session usable?

A. An explore subagent, findings in NOTES.md.

B. Read everything in the main thread.

Simulate the solution

```
# In the browser: open Simulator 4, then Lab 56
cd labs
uv run serve.py

# In Claude Code, from the labs folder
/lab 56

# In a terminal, from simulators/simulator-4-developer-productivity/
uv run explorer.py --case UC-D3
```

What you should see

An explore subagent runs, and NOTES.md names calculate_total and report.py.

An explore subagent ran; NOTES.md names calculate_total and report.py.

Open `simulators/simulator-4-developer-productivity/evidence/` and find it yourself.

The answer

A. An explore subagent, findings in NOTES.md.

Check yourself

- explore subagent spawned
- tool rows with agent=explore exist
- NOTES.md mentions calculate_total and a caller

Now change one thing

Edit the prompt_template in this lab's file under cases/, rerun with --case, and check tool_log.jsonl for what changed.